

If you ignore whether the pattern is a single- or two-diagonal configuration, a downward breakout will happen 26% of the time and an upward breakout will happen 74% of the time. That's the benchmark for the breakout direction (from [Table 23.4](#)), which is what I want to test.

I sorted the diamonds into single- and two-diagonal shapes and sorted by whether the top or the bottom of the pattern came first. The configuration shown at AB in the figure, where it's a single diagonal with the bottom coming before the top, is supposed to break out downward. I found that worked only 28% of the time. That's better than the benchmark's 26%, but it's well short of the 72% that break out upward. In other words, it's more correct to say the pattern breaks out upward most often.

Configuration CD shows a single diagonal with the bottom coming after the top. His technique says these types of diamonds break out upward. Indeed they do 81% of the time compared to the benchmark's 74% of the time. That's a handy improvement.

Two-diagonal. For two-diagonal patterns, I checked whether the top or bottom came first and checked the breakout direction. The *benchmark* rate doesn't change with 26% of diamonds breaking out downward and the other 74% breaking out upward.

For two-diagonal patterns, when the bottom (F) happened before the top (E in pattern EFG), I found they break out downward 26% of the time. That ties the benchmark, but far from the 74% that break out upward.

The two-diagonal, bottom (H) after the top pattern (I in HIJ pattern), correctly predicts an upward breakout 76% of the time. That's slightly better than the 74% benchmark. Of course, Toshchakov doesn't claim that the two-diagonal has a defined breakout pattern, but I checked anyway. [Figures 23.1](#) and [23.2](#) show two-diagonal patterns, and both have upward breakouts. [Figure 23.4](#) shows a two-diagonal diamond with a downward breakout.

How do you apply this to your trading? *When the bottom comes after the top, expect an upward breakout.* Two configurations meet that test: the single diagonal, top before bottom, shown as CD in [Figure 23.6](#), and the two-diagonal pattern HIJ. Expect an upward breakout 76% to 81% of the time on average, depending on whether it's a single- or two-diagonal pattern.